

English for IT Professionals - Lesson 12

Interview Prep I

April 2026

Lead-in

Discuss

- **What is the most common recruitment process that you have experienced so far?**
- **Which round is the most challenging to you?**
- **What feedback did you get from your most recent interview? Was it more about your English proficiency or your technical skills?**

List of behavioral questions

Pick 5 from this list of behvioral questions. Add more if there are no matching questions to your needs.

1. Tell me about yourself
2. Tell me about a project you're proud of
3. Why are you leaving your current job?
4. What do you look for in a new work environment?
5. Tell me about a time you failed or made a mistake
6. What's your biggest weakness?
7. Tell me about a time you had to learn something new quickly
8. Tell me about a time you worked with a difficult team member
9. Tell me about a time you missed a deadline. How did you handle it?
10. Tell me about a time you worked with cross-functional teams

List of technical questions - Front end

Pick 5 from this list. Add more if there are no matching questions to your needs.

1. How did you identify the performance bottleneck?
2. How do you approach state management in a large app?
3. Walk me through your testing strategy
4. How would you architect a codebase for 50+ engineers?
5. Tell me about a time your technical decision conflicted with stakeholders
6. How do you use AI tools to support your daily work?

List of technical questions - Mobile

Pick 3 from this list. Add more if there are no matching questions to your needs.

1. How did you identify and debug a battery/performance issue?
2. Describe your app architecture — why that pattern?
3. How do you handle networking, errors, and offline scenarios?
4. How would you structure a large Flutter codebase for multiple teams?
5. Tell me about a major codebase migration or version upgrade
6. How do you use AI tools in your daily Flutter development?

Today’s Focus

1. Tell me about yourself
2. Tell me about a project you're proud of
3. What do you look for in a new work environment?

Learning and Practice Process

ANALYSIS →
FRAMEWORK →
SAMPLE ANSWER →
VOCAB +
STRUCTURES →
PRACTICE →
DRAFT

- **Analysis:** Understand what the interviewer is really looking for — and what mistakes to avoid
- **Framework:** Learn a structure for answering — and understand why it works
- **Sample Answer:** Read and study a full model answer
- **Vocab & Structures:** Extract the key language patterns you can reuse
- **Practice:** Translate sentences + unscramble a full answer
- **Draft:** Write your own answer using the template provided

QI ANALYSIS

Narrative clarity

Can you summarise your career in a clear, logical way?

Communication skills

Are you fluent, confident, and able to prioritise what matters?

Self-awareness

Do you know what you're good at, what you want, and where you're heading?

Role fit

Does your answer connect to the position they're hiring for?

MISTAKES

Tip: Use links to go to a different page inside your presentation. Links work best for pages like this one!

How: Highlight text, click on the link symbol on the toolbar, and select the page in your presentation that you want to connect.

Kindly delete this note after editing this page. Thank you!

- Problem
- Existing Alternatives
- Solution
- Key Metrics
- Unique Value Proposition
- High-Level Concept
- Unfair Advantage
- Channels
- Consumer Segments
- Early Adopters
- Cost Structure
- Revenue Streams

MISTAKES TO AVOID

MISTAKE	AND WHY IT HURTS
Reciting your entire CV from beginning to end	Too long, no clear highlight, the interviewer loses focus
Drowning the answer in technical jargon	Loses connection with interviewers from a different stack
No link to the role you're applying for	Sounds like you're applying everywhere randomly
Too short — "I'm a developer with 5 years"	No depth, not memorable
Covering personal life in detail	Not relevant in a professional context

WHAT A STRONG ANSWER LOOKS LIKE

- Tells a logical story: past → present → growth → connect to this role
- Sounds natural — not memorised word for word
- Is specific — real projects, real technologies, real impact
- Closes with a reason why you're sitting in this interview today
- Runs approximately 1.5 to 2 minutes — not shorter than 90 seconds, not longer than 2.5

FRAMEWORK

Framework: PAST → PRESENT → GROWTH → CONNECT

PAST (30–40 sec)

Where did you start? What did you study or do?
→ Education + early career foundation

PRESENT (45–60 sec)

What are you doing now? What are you good at?
→ Current role, key project, area of passion

GROWTH (20–30 sec)

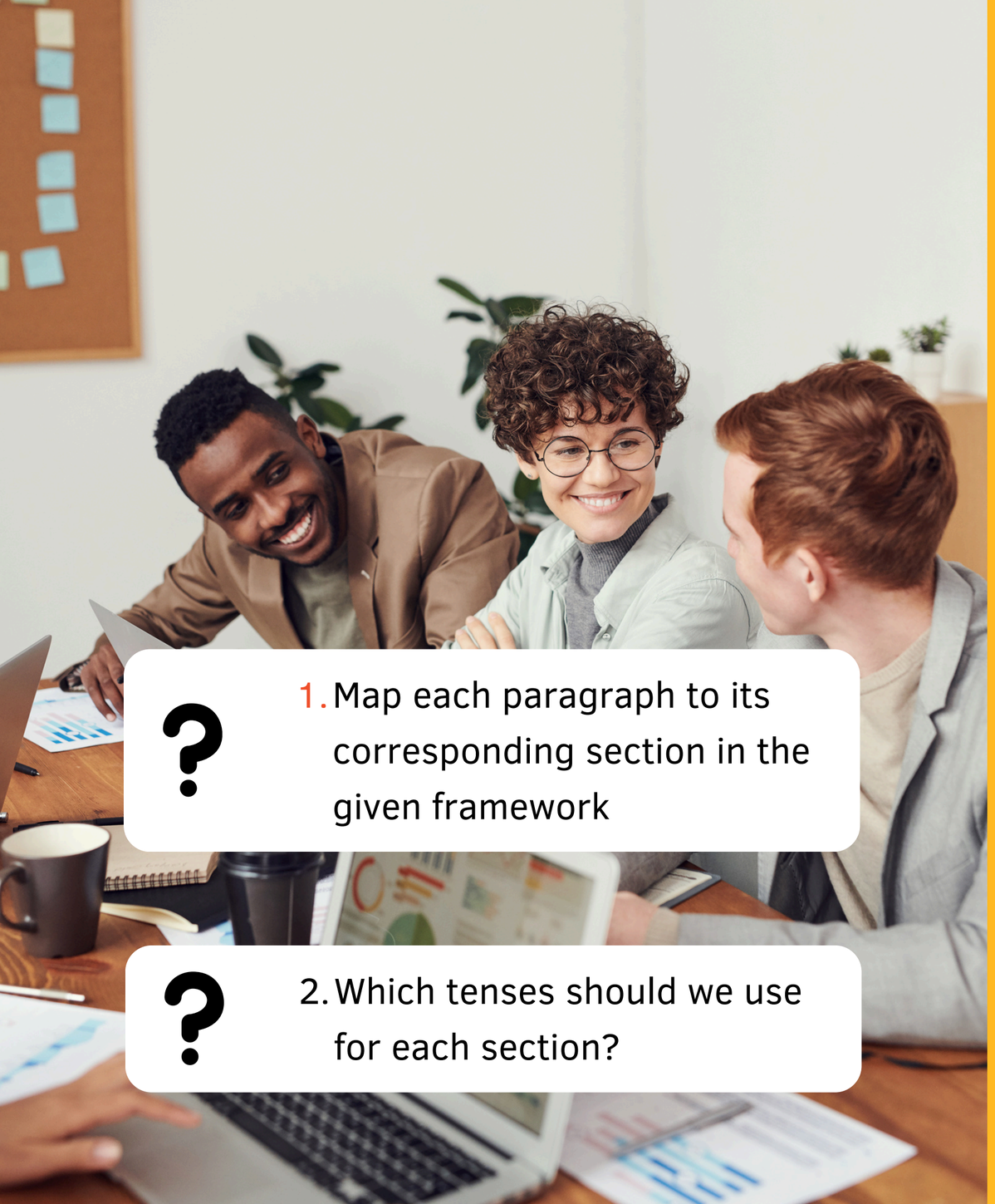
How do you actively keep developing? → Shows you are proactive, not stagnant

CONNECT (20–30 sec)

Why this role? What do you bring?
→ Bridge to this specific opportunity

WHY THIS FRAMEWORK?

- PAST gives context — the interviewer understands where your foundation comes from
- PRESENT gives credibility — this is your proof: what you own, what you've built
- GROWTH gives depth — senior engineers don't just execute; they invest in themselves
- ONNECT gives purpose — it ties your story to this role and this company



1. Map each paragraph to its corresponding section in the given framework

2. Which tenses should we use for each section?

I'm a software developer with over [number] years of experience, specializing in [frontend development / mobile development with Flutter]. My journey started with a [major name] degree, which gave me a solid foundation in programming fundamentals and problem-solving.

Throughout my career, I've worked with [JavaScript, React, and TypeScript / Dart and Flutter], and I've been particularly focused on building [user-friendly, scalable web applications / performant mobile apps]. In my most recent role at [Company], I was part of a team that [developed a cloud-based logistics management system / built a consumer-facing mobile app from the ground up]. That project really sharpened both my technical skills and my ability to collaborate — we had to move fast and coordinate across frontend, backend, and product constantly.

I'm someone who's always eager to keep growing. Outside of project work, I regularly take on new learning — whether that's online courses to stay current, or contributing to open-source to sharpen my skills in a different context.

I'm excited about the opportunity to bring my [diverse skill set / experience in Flutter and mobile architecture / background in frontend performance], my passion for [building scalable, user-friendly products / clean and maintainable code], and my collaborative spirit to your team. I look forward to contributing to [the kind of large-scale engineering challenges your platform presents / your mobile product and the technical problems that come with that scale] and being part of [a team that's known for engineering excellence / an environment where engineers have real ownership over what they build].

Language Focus: Useful Sentences -Opening

I'm a [role] with over [X] years of experience

Example: I'm a software developer with over five years of experience

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I'm a [role] specialising in [area]

Example: I'm a mobile developer specialising in Flutter

My background is in [area], with a focus on [specific]

Example: My background is in frontend development, with a focus on performance

Language Focus: Useful Sentences -PAST

My journey started with [education / first role], which gave me a solid foundation in [skill / area]

Example: My journey started with a Computer Science degree, which gave me a solid foundation in programming fundamentals

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Throughout my career, I've worked with [tech stack]

Example: Throughout my career, I've worked with Dart, Flutter, and Firebase

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I've been particularly focused on [area]

Example: I've been particularly focused on building scalable mobile apps

Language Focus: Useful Sentences -Present

In my most recent role at [Company], I [did what]

Example: In my most recent role at XYZ, I was part of a team that built...

That project really sharpened my [skill]

Example: That project really sharpened both my technical skills and my ability to collaborate

I'm particularly passionate about [specific thing]

Example: I'm particularly passionate about creating user-friendly, efficient solutions

Language Focus: Useful Sentences -Growth

I'm someone who's always eager to [grow / learn / improve]

Example: I'm someone who's always eager to keep growing

Outside of project work, I regularly [activity]

Example: Outside of project work, I regularly take online courses to stay current

I stay updated with [area] by [how]

Example: I stay updated with the latest Flutter developments by following the official blog and contributing to open source

Language Focus: Useful Sentences -Connect

I'm excited about the opportunity to bring [X] to your team

Example: I'm excited about the opportunity to bring my Flutter expertise and collaborative spirit to your team

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I look forward to contributing to [specific Y]

Example: I look forward to contributing to your mobile platform and the engineering challenges at that scale

Translate V-E

Translate each sentence from Vietnamese to English using the target structures if applicable

1. Hành trình của tôi bắt đầu với tấm bằng Khoa học Máy tính, từ đó tôi có được nền tảng vững chắc về lập trình và tư duy giải quyết vấn đề."

→ My journey started with a Computer Science degree, which gave me a solid foundation in programming and problem-solving.

2. Trong suốt sự nghiệp, tôi đã làm việc chủ yếu với Dart và Flutter, và đặc biệt tập trung vào việc xây dựng các ứng dụng di động hiệu năng cao, thân thiện với người dùng.

→ Throughout my career, I've worked primarily with Dart and Flutter, and I've been particularly focused on building high-performance, user-friendly mobile applications.

3. Ở vị trí gần đây nhất tại Tiki, tôi là thành viên của một team xây dựng ứng dụng thương mại điện tử trên Flutter từ đầu. Dự án đó thực sự đã mài giũa cả kỹ năng kỹ thuật lẫn khả năng làm việc nhóm của tôi — chúng tôi phải di chuyển nhanh và phối hợp liên tục giữa frontend, backend và product.

→ In my most recent role at Tiki, I was part of a team that built an e-commerce app on Flutter from the ground up. That project really sharpened both my technical skills and my ability to collaborate — we had to move fast and coordinate constantly across frontend, backend, and product.

Translate V-E

Translate each sentence from Vietnamese to English using the target structures if applicable

4. Tôi là người luôn háo hức học hỏi và phát triển. Ngoài công việc dự án, tôi thường xuyên học các khoá online để cập nhật những thay đổi mới nhất của Flutter, và đóng góp vào các dự

→ I'm someone who's always eager to learn and grow. Outside of project work, I regularly take online courses to stay updated with the latest Flutter developments, and I contribute to open-source projects to sharpen my skills in different contexts.

5. Tôi rất hào hứng với cơ hội được mang kinh nghiệm Flutter và tinh thần cộng tác của mình đến team của các bạn. Tôi mong được đóng góp vào kiến trúc và hiệu năng của ứng dụng ở quy mô hàng triệu người dùng, và trở thành một phần của team mà ở đó các kỹ sư thực sự làm chủ những gì họ xây dựng.

→ I'm excited about the opportunity to bring my Flutter expertise and collaborative spirit to your team. I look forward to contributing to the architecture and performance of your app at millions-of-users scale, and being part of a team where engineers have real ownership over what they build.

Common expressions used in a self-intro

OPENING → PAST → PRESENT → GROWTH → CONNECT

Arrange the expressions in the correct order to form a logical self-intro

4-2-6-5-3-1

1. I'm excited about the opportunity to bring my experience in scalable mobile development and my collaborative spirit to your team — I look forward to contributing to the engineering challenges your platform presents and being part of a team known for technical excellence.
2. My journey started with a Computer Science degree, which gave me a solid foundation in programming fundamentals and problem-solving.
3. I'm someone who's always eager to keep growing — outside of project work, I regularly take online courses and contribute to open-source projects to stay sharp.
4. I'm a mobile developer with over five years of experience, specialising in Flutter.
5. In my most recent role at [Company], I was part of a team that built a consumer-facing mobile app from the ground up — that project really sharpened both my technical skills and my ability to collaborate under pressure.
6. Throughout my career, I've worked primarily with Dart and Flutter, and I've been particularly focused on building performant, user-friendly mobile experiences.

Draft your own answer

OPENING → PAST → PRESENT → GROWTH → CONNECT

1. [OPENING — 1 sentence]

1.1 I'm a [your role: e.g., mobile developer / frontend engineer] with over [X] years of experience, specialising in [your area: e.g., Flutter / React / full-stack].

2. [PAST — 2–3 sentences]

2.1 My journey started with [education / first role / how you entered tech].

2.2 ...which gave me a solid foundation in [what skills or mindset?].

2.3 Throughout my career, I've worked with [your main tech stack].

2.4 I've been particularly focused on [your core area of expertise].

3. [PRESENT — 3–4 sentences]

3.1 In my most recent role at [Company], I [what did you do — be specific].

3.2 I'm particularly passionate about [what kind of problems or solutions?].

3.3 That project / this role really sharpened my [technical skill + soft skill].

3.4 [Optional: We had to [challenge] — which taught me a lot about [lesson].]

4. [GROWTH — 2 sentences]

4.1 I'm someone who's always eager to learn and grow.

4.2 Outside of project work, I regularly [how do you stay current? e.g., take online courses / follow engineering blogs / contribute to open-source].

5. [CLOSING — 2 sentences — must be specific to the company you're applying to]

5.1 I'm excited about the opportunity to bring

5.2 [your specific skills + collaborative spirit] to your team.

1. I look forward to contributing to
2. [something specific about their product / tech / challenges]
3. and being part of
4. [something specific about their team / culture / values — research this].



Role-play

Scenario: Propose technial solutions

Let’s role-play a technical solution proposal meeting where one developer presents a solution, and the rest of the team contributes their input to reach alignment.

Presenter

- Present solution options
- Provide pros and cons of each option
- Compare options together
- Suggest an implementation timeline
- Make final decision

Other members

- Ask clarifying questions
- Give more details about technical feasibility from a personal perspective

Homework



RECORD YOUR SELF-INTRO

Record your self-introduction. Share your recording in the Zalo group to receive detailed feedback.